ineffective (Bond 2005, 2009). The Programme for Infrastructure Development in Africa, while difficult to implement, offered systems of financing beyond the diminishing pool of Chinese credit.

However, it is also critical to concede that the forms of BRICS sub-imperialism are diverse, for as Moyo and Yeros (2011:19) remark,

> Some are driven by private blocs of capital with strong state support (Brazil, India); others, like China, include the direct participation of state-owned enterprises; while in the case of South Africa, it is increasingly difficult to speak of an autonomous domestic bourgeoisie, given the extreme degree of de-nationalisation of its economy in the post-apartheid period. The degree of participation in the Western military project is also different from one case to the next although, one might say, there is a 'schizophrenia' to all this, typical of 'sub-imperialism'.

In sum, the recent period has reignited a fruitful debate about the concept of sub-imperialism and about the truncated nature of aspirant transitions from sub- to inter-imperialism, and perhaps also one day – in the wake of future social revolutions against BRICS elites – to anti-imperialism. However, the most critical factor in making this debate real, not just a struggle over semantics between impotent leftist intellectuals, is a different process entirely, one not contingent upon rhetoric from above, but upon reality from below. That reality is increasingly tense in each of the main sub-imperialist powers currently seeking unity, the BRICS.

Such local struggles are impulsive and impossible to predict (as discussed in this book's final chapters), but much deeper class struggles against super-exploitation, ecological destruction and neoliberalism are unfolding constantly in each site. The challenge for BRICS critics from below is to link and internationalise as quickly as possible, because their interests and campaigning analyses, strategies, tactics and alliances have many points of overlap, with each other and with the world's progressive forces. Only then will a genuine global anti-imperialist project become possible, i.e. when anti-sub-imperialists of the world also unite.

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